



PROGRESS REPORT

Central African Republic: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-27 · 94 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-27.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	The 2024-2028 national development plan remains the frame for the digital agenda, cited at a ministry platform launch in February 2026. The national development plan has been the governing framework since 2024 and is cited as the frame for the ministry platform launched in February 2026 , reported again in March . It did not move in the window. There is no separate digital strategy on this ledger: the plan carries the agenda, and the round-table mobilisation total the ministry states for it appears in a source that reads as a rewritten press release and is not independently corroborated. The one sector plan that exists is for public finances, reported under data governance, and its costed operational version is still unpublished.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	The public finances digitalisation plan names a data governance policy among six systems and a data centre; no text, date or status for it is held. The 2025-2027 plan was presented naming an electronic tax platform, a treasury system, procurement and payroll systems, a Tier IV data centre and a data governance policy, none of them priced . The costed operational plan is still unpublished and the named data governance policy is the only such instrument on file, with no text, date or status. 2026-07-02 — a public finance review estimates that digitising the tax administration could raise up to two points of national output in additional revenue in the short term, and recommends electronic public procurement and a digital cadastre over the longer term, against domestic revenue of about FCFA 187bn or 10.1% of output in a 2025 budget of about FCFA 385bn . It is the first independent assessment of the plan's subject matter the base holds. So the fiscal case for digitisation is now made by an outside institution, and the policy the state named to govern the data it would collect does not exist as a document.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The data protection law has been in force since January 2024 with no implementing decree, and none appeared in the window. The law was promulgated in January 2024 as a comprehensive regime with no supervisory authority and no implementing decree , and that remains the position . The held text is a scan with a poor character layer, so its wording is legible and individual characters are not reliable. Nothing moved it in the twelve months to 2026-08-26: no decree, no amendment and no first application. The authority the law creates is reported below and does not exist either, so a comprehensive statute has been in force for nineteen months with neither the rules nor the body needed to apply it.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	The cybersecurity and cybercrime law has been in force since early 2024 carrying six to ten year sentences, and is named as the instrument now used against online content. The law was voted by acclamation in January 2024 and has been in force since, carrying six to ten year sentences and fines of FCFA 5m to 10m . Its text is unchanged and the statute itself is not held, which is a standing acquisition target. 2026-07-29 – a commentator names it as the instrument now used against online content . That is an opinion column rather than a record of prosecutions, so what the base can state is the claim and not a case. The agency the same law creates has never been established, reported under cybersecurity readiness, so the enforcement side of the statute runs through the ordinary criminal process.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Data protection	Data protection authority	The data protection authority is eighteen months past its statutory establishment deadline, its functions vesting in the supervising ministry meanwhile. A twelve-month statutory deadline for establishing the authority expired in January 2025 with no establishment recorded, and the statute vests its functions in the supervising ministry in the meantime . The law that creates it was promulgated in January 2024 . Eighteen months past the deadline, nothing has moved. The sanction ceiling the unfilled body would wield is 5% of the last closed year's pre-tax turnover , so the gap between the regime on paper and the regime in operation is the whole of the enforcement. Data protection supervision therefore sits with the ministry that also sponsors the identity, payments and platform programmes reported in this document.	NO CHANGE
Data protection	National data protection readiness		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	The minister met a development-bank delegation on joining the six-country regional digital integration programme; no financing agreement, amount or date is recorded. 2026-03-06 – talks were reported on joining the six-country regional programme covering broadband, cross-border interconnection, secure public platforms and digital skills, with no figure, signature or follow-up since . The source is a secondary aggregator with quotes attributed to a wire service and the meeting date is not stated, so participation is reported intent rather than finance. Nothing has followed in five months. The programme is the obvious route to the cross-border interconnection and the secure platform layer the country lacks, and it is the only accession discussion on this ledger.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	A police circular applies community free movement on biometric documents at every border post, admitting community citizens for up to 90 days. A police circular of September 2024 applies the community free-movement rules at every border post, admitting community citizens for stays of up to 90 days on a valid biometric national identity card, community identity card, biometric passport or approved community passport, implementing an additional act of April 2019 on common migration policy . A neighbouring state issued equivalent instructions the same month. Nothing in the window changed it. It is the only instance on this ledger of a regional legal instrument being applied domestically by an operational order, and it depends on documents whose issuance is reported under digital identity as priced informally at one prefecture.	NO CHANGE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	A community interoperable payment-code standard launched in July 2026 across the six member states, and a regional data-centre programme names a facility here. 2026-07-30 – the regional central bank and the payments body launched an interoperable payment-code standard binding across the six member states, routed and settled through the regional switch and secured to card-industry standards . No country-specific adoption step is on file, and the country's share of regional payment volume was 0.43% in 2024 . 2026-08-25 – a regional programme at definition stage, 25% progress, plans six new data centres across the community including one here, alongside reinforcement of five existing centres, at a stated total of US\$9.00m across eleven countries . The prospectus states a programme total rather than a country allocation. Both are cases of the region supplying what the country has not built: there is no national data centre, reported under storage, and no domestic payments standard on this ledger.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National quality standards	A spectrum-monitoring system was delivered in June 2025 and a quality-of-service package remains under contract, with a publication site financed and not live. A spectrum contract signed in October 2024 completed in June 2025, and a quality-of-service package signed the same month carries no completion date, unchanged at the February 2026 revision of the procurement plan . The plan's actual-amount column is unpopulated throughout, so no contract value is published. 2026-02-02 – the minister stated the regulator had obtained financing for a website publishing operators' quality-of-service data . No site was recorded live on a third test in July 2026, and the regulator still publishes no statistics of any kind. If delivered it would close the standing absence of any independent measurer in this country: every connectivity figure in this report comes from an operator, a ministry or an international estimate.	ADVANCED
Standards	Adoption of international standards		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	The communications council asked for tighter subscriber identification and for platform account closures, acknowledging that its own competence covers media professionals. 2026-06-12 – at a press conference the communications council's president requested better control of subscriber identification to limit anonymous accounts, activation of international judicial cooperation against content produced abroad, and cooperation with international platforms on reporting and closing accounts . No instrument was adopted, and the council acknowledged that its own competence covers media professionals rather than the general public. Nothing else on this ledger touches online expression except the cybersecurity statute reported under legislation, which a commentator names as the instrument now used against online content. So the requests describe an intention to reach beyond an existing mandate, and the law that would already reach there is in force.	NO CHANGE requests to restrict anonymity made and no instrument adopted

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	Two private-invoice lines carry FCFA 1,000,000,000 and FCFA 500,000,000 for 2026, while the digital agency's transfer includes FCFA 118,000,000 for six months of unpaid salaries. The largest digital lines are unexplained. Two named private-invoice lines carry FCFA 1,000,000,000 and FCFA 500,000,000 for 2026, the first doubled in a year and quadrupled in two , the second having no predecessor in 2024 or 2025 ; the estimates state no purpose for either payment in any year, and together they are 21 times the digital ministry's entire investment title. The digital development agency's transfer is split into FCFA 300,000,000 for urban optical loops and FCFA 118,000,000 to clear six months of unpaid 2024 salaries , an eightfold rise in two years of which a quarter is arrears on its own staff's pay. The state also budgets FCFA 250,000,000 of telephone arrears to its own incumbent for a third year , while negotiating that operator's privatisation. Elsewhere the money is real and small: FCFA 420,000,000 for customs system deployment, the largest digital line outside the digital ministry , and FCFA 1,600,000,000 transferred to the regulator against its own draft budget of FCFA 6,200,000,000 . All of it sits inside a 2026 budget carrying a FCFA 28bn deficit with public investment down 2.06% . No enacted appropriation and no outturn is extractable for any year.	MIXED the digital vote's largest lines are unexplained private-invoice transfers while the agency delivering it is budgeting arrears on its own staff's pay
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	Three digital financial services accords were signed in November 2025, while a data-centre memorandum signed in January 2025 never advanced to contract. 2025-11-10 – three accords were signed: an institutional one with the finance ministry aligned to a development institution's 2030 strategy and the national plan, one with a commercial bank on its participation in digital services, and one with the incumbent mobile operator on building the capacity of its distributor network . No commitment sum is stated for any of the three. Against them, a data-centre memorandum signed in January 2025 has never advanced to contract, and at July 2026 there was still no contract, site or financing . It is one of five live proposals circling the same unbuilt national data centre, and a twelve-month absence of movement is the finding. The pattern is consistent across this ledger: agreements are signed at ceremonies, and the ones that convert are the ones with an implementing partner already in country.	MIXED three financial-sector accords signed while a data-centre memorandum stood dormant for a year
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Development-partner project financing	The public sector digital governance project revised its procurement plan in February 2026, with no disbursement figure later than 33% held against a December 2026 closing date. A US\$35m grant approved in May 2022 and closing December 2026, plus US\$6.4m of additional financing appraised in May 2025, had disbursed US\$11.35m or 33% at April 2025 . 2026-02-23 – the procurement plan was revised, recording two regulator packages as signed and one completed , with no later disbursement figure held. The funder's own record of procurement performance is candidly poor: planned dates not respected, weak document quality and evaluation committees not held on time. A project a third disbursed with ten months to closing is the single largest digital financing on this ledger. Everything it has delivered that the base can name – the spectrum system, the regulator packages – sits inside the regulator, and the exchange layer, data centre and identity system the country lacks are not among them.	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	A third operator launched fourth-generation service in the capital, while subscribers at a northern town had no calls, no internet and no mobile money for close to a month. 2026-05-14 – the third operator launched fourth-generation service in the capital, completing commercial service at all three , having been licensed in December 2025 against one operator live since May 2025 . A licence is not coverage: fourth-generation population coverage was measured at 0.3% in 2023 . 2026-07-28 – subscribers at a northern town reported no calls, no internet and no mobile money for close to a month, with no restoration date, and some officials unpaid for the previous month because salary transfers run over mobile services . Single-operator dependency with no redundancy, attributed to off-grid relay sites, equipment theft and repair crews travelling hundreds of kilometres. The instrument that would fix that is dormant: the country's first passive-infrastructure licence for pylons, antennas and technical sites to be built and leased to the operators was signed in July 2025 fourteen days before the window opened, and no tower count, site build or lease has been recorded since.	MIXED all three operators now hold fourth-generation licences while one town lost every service for a month

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Internet usage	Internet use is put at about 670,000 users, 12.0%, at October 2025, while the state's higher figures describe coverage rather than use. 2025-11-08 — an end-2025 measurement puts users at about 670,000, 12.0%, at October 2025, with 2.49m mobile subscriptions and 38.1% penetration at end-2025 , against an earlier international estimate of 13.8% for 2024 and a publisher estimate of 15.5% in January 2025. The publisher reports fewer users against a larger population, so the earlier figure is withdrawn rather than showing a decline. Government statements of about 30% describe network coverage rather than use , and the two are routinely conflated. Every penetration figure held traces to a single international estimate redistributed by intermediaries, and the regulator publishes none — so there is no independent measurer of the most basic number in this report.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	Satellite service costs about 136% of monthly income per head, at FCFA 33,000 a month plus tax with a kit at FCFA 240,000, against a 2% international threshold. 2026-03-16 — commercial service opened at FCFA 33,000 a month plus tax with a standard kit at FCFA 240,000, a monthly price of about 136% of monthly income per head against an international affordability threshold of 2% . The object advanced and affordability did not, and the state's response was to suspend non-homologated kits rather than to address price. That is the only published price of any kind on this ledger. No mobile tariff, data basket, handset price or regulator price schedule appears for the country at any date, so a service costing more than a month's income per head is the country's one affordability datapoint.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	The backbone holds 935 km in service and gained nothing through the window, against a 12,000 km commitment stated by the minister. 935 km of terrestrial and sub-fluvial fibre is in service on the Bangui-Douala corridor with spurs to Cameroon and Congo , and no new kilometrage, commissioning or route was added through the window. The minister's claim of about 1,200 km in July 2025 is unverified and the development bank is the announcer of record for the 935 km. The 2026 estimates appropriate FCFA 2,000,000 to connect prefecture capitals to Bangui over it . 2026-02-02 — against that, the minister stated a 12,000 km fibre commitment at the ministry's orientations ceremony , with no contract, financing, route, phasing or timetable held and no progress in the six months since. The figure is roughly ten times the backbone built to date and reaches this base through a speech. A two-million-franc line to connect the prefectures and a twelve-thousand-kilometre announcement are the two ends of the same year's policy.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	A national internet exchange point was created in January 2026, known to the base only through a foreign operator's investor filing. 2026-01 – an internet exchange point was created, described as reinforcing digital sovereignty , where none existed. The date carries month precision and the sole source is an operator's half-year investor filing: no government instrument, membership list, peering agreement or traffic figure is held. That an exchange point's creation reaches this base through a foreign shareholder's financial report rather than through the regulator is the sharpest illustration of the measurement problem in this country. The regulator publishes nothing, reported under quality standards, and its own quality-of-service site is financed and not live.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Satellite broadband went commercially live in March 2026 with 450 government kits, and the regulator began a field sweep against unregistered access points in August. 2026-03-16 – the service went commercially live as the operator's 27th African market, with 450 government kits , on a convention signed in December 2025 with United States embassy involvement . No licence and no service existed before. Enforcement followed at once. Roaming was deactivated on kits acquired abroad that had not met homologation conditions, on traceability and national-security grounds , six weeks after commercial launch . 2026-08-12 – the regulator began a control operation across named capital neighbourhoods identifying unregistered internet-access points, with the ministry estimating about 3,000 users in the country against 200 registered, and the operation to extend progressively to provincial cities . The ratio is the ministry's own estimate, no register total is published, and two of the operators visited said they had not been told registration was required. What limits the service is its price rather than its reach, and that is reported below.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	Nothing is built: a vendor package puts a national Tier III data centre as its first axis, the fifth thread on the same unbuilt facility. Two ministry facilities were recorded under construction in 2022 with no completion record , and a memorandum signed in January 2025 never advanced . 2026-05-27 — a vendor delegation met the ministry on a four-axis package whose first axis is a national Tier III data centre , confirmed the following week . The 2026 pitch repeats a 2022 target for the same facility: five threads, three sponsors, and nothing built at July 2026. The same package's second axis is a dedicated network of five microwave-relay sites interconnecting ministries, with no contract, site list, financing or timetable held . So the state's hosting position is unchanged and its ministries remain unconnected to each other, which is what the minister's own January 2026 statement about heterogeneous state information systems describes.	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	A 25 MWp solar plant with 30 MWh of storage cut dependence on diesel generation by 90% and raised domestic generation capacity by 40%. 2025-02-10 — a 25 MWp solar plant with 30 MWh of battery storage was reported in service, cutting dependence on diesel generation by 90% and raising domestic generation capacity by 40%, with prepaid metering installed for all non-essential public facilities and the national utility's commercial systems revamped . No utility report, tariff schedule or commissioning record was on file before it. The record is about national supply and no source ties that generation to digital infrastructure specifically. It matters here because the data centre repeatedly proposed and never built, reported under storage, would need firm power in a country whose access rate is reported under rural electrification, and because the utility's own billing has now moved onto mobile money, reported under payments.	ADVANCED
Energy	Grid reliability		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Rural electrification	Electricity access was 17% in 2023, from 14.3% in 2022 with about 0.4% rural, and nothing later is held. Access stood at 17% in 2023, from 14.3% in 2022 when the capital was about 35% and rural access about 0.4% . The figure reaches this base through a secondary aggregator citing development-bank data, and nothing later is held. Rural access below one per cent is the physical constraint under every connectivity item in this report: the off-grid relay sites blamed for the month-long provincial outage, reported under mobile penetration, are the same constraint expressed as a service failure. No electrification programme, target or rural energy instrument appears anywhere on this ledger.	NO CHANGE
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	A payroll clean-up removing more than 2,000 ghost workers was built by the national informatics office, and nothing later is held. A payroll clean-up removing more than 2,000 ghost workers, built by the national informatics office, is recorded as a project achievement . No later headcount, payroll-value or coverage figure is held, and nothing is dated inside the window. It is the only state management system on file with a delivered result, and the only evidence of a domestic technical unit building anything. Everything else described in this report is a vendor package, a donor project or a platform whose builder is not named — including the ministry-wide planning platform reported under electronic services, whose vendor pre-financed earlier phases from its own funds with no stated recovery mechanism. No workforce, skills or technical-capacity source exists for the country at any date.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	The national cybersecurity agency appears in no estimates volume for a third year, and the 2026 programme budget carries FCFA 6,000,000 in total for network security and digital trust. The agency was created by the January 2024 cybersecurity law under joint supervision, to secure information systems, handle alerts and regulate the sector, with no establishment record . It appears nowhere in the 2024, 2025 or 2026 estimates under any wording ; a search for the word cyber returns nothing across 602 pages of estimates and 183 pages of programme budget. What is appropriated is FCFA 4,000,000 for network and information-system security and FCFA 2,000,000 for digital trust – FCFA 6,000,000 for the whole country for the year, against FCFA 1,600,000,000 transferred from the same ministry to the regulator. The one capability the base can point to as delivered rather than announced is a cybersecurity and electronic-certification platform listed in a funder's delivered scope at the backbone inauguration , with no operator, uptake or certificate-issuance record, and no held source names it again. A 2022 appraisal found the country had no strategy, response team or operations centre and nothing has updated it in four years.	NO CHANGE

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	A US\$13m digital identity system was announced with an implementation window of 2027 to 2032, while police at one prefecture are reported demanding FCFA 100,000 to 200,000 for a card whose legal price is FCFA 4,500. 2025-11-28 – a US\$13m integrated system built around a unique identification number, managed by a new identification office and unifying existing biometric and civil-registration databases, was announced with an implementation window of 2027 to 2032 and assessments, procurement and an international tender still ahead . It is an announcement rather than delivery, and the account reads as a project communiqué. 2026-06-16 – the existing credential moved the other way. The legal tariff of FCFA 4,500, restored by interministerial order in June 2025 after five years of overcharging , holds on paper while at one prefecture police are reported to serve one religious group first and to demand FCFA 100,000 to 200,000 from another, requiring the father's and grandfather's birth certificates . The card is the gateway document for the electoral roll and most administrative access, so the movement is in access and price rather than in technology. The second document rail is unchanged: biometric passport issuance resumed under a new operator with payment funnelled through only two banks , and no volume, price or coverage record has been held since.	MIXED a national digital identity system announced for 2027 while access to the existing card is priced informally
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	Officials outside the capital are paid by mobile money and went unpaid for a month when one operator's network failed, against 1,702 civil servants enrolled in May 2025. 1,702 civil servants in regions without banking services were being paid by mobile money, recorded as a project achievement in May 2025 . No later enrolment figure is held. 2026-07-28 – at one town subscribers reported no calls, no internet and no mobile money for close to a month, with prepaid bundles expiring unused and some officials unpaid for the previous month . Single-operator dependency with no redundancy is the mechanism. A payroll rail that fails for a month is not a payroll rail. The state has moved salaries onto a private network in places where it has no alternative, and nothing on this ledger records a fallback, a service-level obligation or a redundancy requirement on the operator.	STALLED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	The online tax platform launched in March 2025 with four modules and 301 large and 325 medium firms in scope; no filing, payment or coverage figure has been published since. The platform launched officially after adoption and training from January 2025, with four modules including registration for the unique identification number, run by the tax directorate under a 24-month external service contract, and 301 large and 325 medium firms in scope . Nothing on it is dated inside the window, no filing, payment or coverage figure has been published, and the 2026 estimates carry no line for it. The fiscal case for it is now made from outside: a public finance review estimates that digitising the tax administration could raise up to two points of national output in the short term, reported under data governance. The system that would do it has been live for eighteen months and has published nothing about what it collects. Customs is the line with money behind it, reported under domestic financing.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	State electricity bills became payable over mobile money at an official launch in August 2026, on a contract dated October 2025. 2026-08-04 – state electricity bills became officially payable over one operator's mobile-money service, for subscribers including those in five named towns, under a contract dated October 2025 . No tariff, transaction fee, volume, revenue share or exclusivity term is disclosed, the two companies are the only announcers of record and no regulator is named. The report states subscribers were already paying this way before the ceremony, so the launch date belongs to the agreement rather than to first use. It is the first person-to-government payment channel on this ledger and it is a bilateral arrangement between a utility and one operator, in a country where a single operator's month-long outage has already stopped salary payments.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	The country held 0.43% of regional payment-operation volume in 2024, the smallest but one, and no national account count or value figure is published. 2026-04-08 – the regional central bank's 2024 payment-services report puts the country at 0.43% of regional payment-operation volume, the smallest but one, against the largest member state's 65.10% . The report holds no value figure or account count for the country. That share is the only measure of payment uptake on this ledger. No wallet count, transaction total, agent network figure or account-ownership survey appears at any date, and the regulator publishes nothing. The uses that do exist are narrow and state-driven: salaries for officials outside the banking network and, since August 2026, electricity bills – both reported above, both dependent on one operator.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Population register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Civil register	A civil-status modernisation programme targets 400,000 birth certificates by 2028 and put its 2025 activities at 90% complete, beside a 3,000-certificate regional project. 2026-02-20 – a steering committee validated the implementing partner's 2025 activities on an externally funded civil-status modernisation programme run with the territorial administration ministry, extending from a capital-and-corridor pilot to new communes, with a target of 400,000 birth certificates by 2028 and 2025 activities put at 90% complete . It is a single source with no financing figure, contract or end date stated. 2025-08-12 – beside it, a regional birth-registration project targets 3,000 certificates in the country , launched eleven days into the window with no progress, delivery or completion record since. It is an order of magnitude smaller than the modernisation programme. Civil registration is the input to the identity card and to the digital identity system announced for 2027, and both programmes carrying it are externally run.	ADVANCED
Registries	Address register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Business register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Social protection register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Electoral register	The definitive electoral list reached 2,398,158 registered voters, 757,075 of them registered in 2025, used across 3,910 voting centres. 2025-08-23 – the electoral authority published a definitive list of 2,398,158 registered voters, 1,641,083 carried from the 2020 revision plus 757,075 registered in 2025 , used on 28 December 2025 across 3,910 voting centres . Adding almost half again to the roll in one revision is the largest registration operation on this ledger. The defect is small and telling: the authority's own provisional results state a turnout percentage computed on an electorate 5,212 lower than its definitive list , which no source reconciles. The roll rests on the identity card reported above, whose issuance at one prefecture is reported as religiously targeted and informally priced.	ADVANCED
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Land register	122 tokenised plots sold for about US\$38,308 by November 2025, while the cadastre carries FCFA 625,000 for the mining register and FCFA 650,000 for a petroleum database. Tokenised land concessions opened in June 2025 under presidential decree over 1,700 hectares , and 122 plots had sold for about US\$38,308 by November 2025 at a fixed price of about US\$314 each, with a flagged expansion to mineral rights not recorded as happening . The terms are unreconciled between the two accounts, which agree on location but not on pricing. The registry underneath has not been built. A US\$1.6m agreement of April 2024 covered a second phase of public-administration digitalisation including an electronic cadastre , no cadastre delivery record is held, and the 2026 framework carries FCFA 625,000 for updating the mining cadastre and FCFA 650,000 for a petroleum database — FCFA 1,275,000 for the year between them. 2026-07-31 — a memorandum with a Gulf counterparty adds land-administration modernisation to the stated programme , with no commitment figure or governance arrangement.	MIXED land was tokenised and sold while the cadastre it would rest on has no delivery record
Sectoral management information systems	Health	The health ministry runs a routine health information system offering fewer functionalities here than in three comparators, and a remote hospital began using telemedicine. 2025-12-01 — a four-country study of newborn-data functionality finds the health ministry's routine information system offers users here fewer functionalities than in the three comparators , against a US\$70m health service delivery and system strengthening project running since 2022 . No sector management information system was on file before this. 2026-08-18 — a remote hospital is reported using telemedicine to reach a global network of healthcare professionals, run by an international medical organisation . It is an operator-run service at one site rather than a state system, with no case volume, connectivity arrangement or continuity plan published. No education-sector system is on file, so health is the whole of the country's sectoral systems record.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Education		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Tax		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Customs		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	A unified public-services portal launched in December 2025, a whole ministry moved onto one platform, and a treasury single account application was deployed. 2025-12-12 – a single entry point for administrative tasks, request and complaint tracking and access to official documents went live, with expansion to health, education and tax stated as planned . Its external financing attribution is asserted only by the launch report, and no usage, registration or transaction figure is held. 2026-02-27 – one ministry put human resources, budget, document management, project management, macroeconomic modelling and donor-financing tracking on a single platform, with a central register of government, international and humanitarian projects , launched under presidential patronage . The vendor pre-financed earlier phases from its own funds with no stated recovery mechanism, the platform's cost is stated nowhere, and its efficiency figures are projections rather than measurements. 2026-07-28 – a treasury single account application was deployed, tied to regional banking rules, with the stated object of centralising state balances and eliminating parallel and opaque accounts, and integration with the regional settlement rails . No cost, financier, vendor, timetable or number of accounts closed is stated, and the architecture is explicitly regional rather than national.	ADVANCED

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government		NO EVIDENCE
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Control of AI abuse		NO EVIDENCE
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production		NO EVIDENCE
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs		NO EVIDENCE
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	Bitcoin's legal-tender status was revoked, the state token is defunct with the status of invested funds unclear, and the presidential coin lost more than 75% of its value. Parliament amended the April 2022 cryptocurrency law and revoked bitcoin's legal-tender status, making acceptance optional, with no restoration or replacement instrument recorded . The country was the first African state to adopt it. The state-sponsored token is defunct: 10% of a 210-million token target sold, under EUR 2m raised, the promised crypto city and island never built, the website offline and the status of funds already invested recorded as unclear . It had been marketed with passports at US\$60,000 and land at US\$10,000 held in the token . The presidential meme coin passed US\$900m in market capitalisation over its launch weekend and then lost more than 75% of its value , and remains the payment rail for the tokenised land concessions, with no evidence that its revenues were declared as public income or entered the national budget . The rest of the private technology record is two named firms with no dated transaction: no startup, accelerator cohort, funding round or sector revenue figure exists for the country.	REGRESSED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)		NO EVIDENCE
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	A digital training centre and incubator opened at the university in January 2024, and its technology institute supplies most of the country's engineering graduates. A government digital training centre and start-up incubator opened at the university in January 2024, financed jointly by the European Union and a development bank as a component of the fibre backbone project and opened alongside the launch of broadband service . No enrolment, cohort or budget figure has ever been published for it, and nothing on it is dated inside the window. The university's technology institute supplies most of the country's professional engineering graduates in civil, industrial, computing, mining and geological engineering, and runs a master's in engineering sciences , on a standing institutional description carrying no date, enrolment or research-output figure of its own. No digital-literacy programme, skills measurement or training line appears in three consecutive years of estimates.	NO CHANGE
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy		NO EVIDENCE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	The country's first free public access point was inaugurated in April 2026, while the universal service fund is still not operational, with implementation targeted for 2026. 2026-04-24 – the President inaugurated what is presented as the country's first free public internet access point, with technical support from Russian cooperation . It is one site with no bandwidth, uptime, user or funding figure, carried by a pro-government outlet, and the item doubles as campaign copy for a local legislative candidate. The fund that should be doing this work has never operated. The levy was provided for by a 2018 law and a February 2019 decree, its supervising committee's activities launched in July 2025, and effective implementation is named among the regulator's 2026 priorities ; it is financed by a 2% levy on operators' previous-year turnover, with scope covering broadband in schools, health centres, town halls, libraries and post offices . It has never published an amount collected, a balance or an allocation in the seven years since the levy took effect , and no collection figure, project award or operator selection is held.	ADVANCED one public access point opened while the universal service fund reached its eighth year without operating

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The fourth census completed its third data-cleaning phase in August 2026, a household survey opened six months of collection by tablet, and a seventh indicator survey convened its steering committee. 2026-08-06 – the country's first digital census completed the third phase of data cleaning, running since May 2026, as a step toward definitive results, financed through a regional statistics project with a United Nations agency as technical partner . No enumeration total, publication date or provisional result is stated. 2026-07-23 – enumerator teams deployed nationwide for a harmonised household living-conditions survey covering about 7,000 households in three two-month waves, entirely by tablet, with a public commitment to statistical secrecy and aggregates only . The field period ends around January 2027 and no prior harmonised survey is held. 2026-08-18 – a seventh multiple indicator cluster survey convened its steering committee for the first time, budgeted at 1,942,332,190 FCFA or US\$3,531,513, of which about 1.1 billion FCFA was mobilised – about 43 per cent unmobilised on the institute's own figures, with no fieldwork or publication date stated. Three national collections running at once is the most active part of the country's digital record.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	National accounts were rebased from a 2005 to a 2019 base under the newer standard, the review's aide-memoire published in August 2026. 2026-08-07 – national accounts moved from a 2005 base under the 1993 standard to a 2019 base under the 2008 standard, drawing on the 2021 agriculture survey and the harmonised household survey to widen coverage of agriculture, household consumption, self-build, imputed rent and informal activity, with the joint technical and peer review held in February 2023 and its aide-memoire released publicly under a World Bank-financed project . The review it documents was held three years before publication: what is new is the publication, and no rebased output level is stated in the record held. Publication three years after the work is the pattern of this country's statistics, and it is better than the alternative visible elsewhere in this report – a complete quarterly budget execution series published on time as page-image scans whose digits do not extract, with settled accounts running only to 2019.	ADVANCED
Open data	Use of open data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	The incumbent operator's privatisation entered an operational phase in July 2026 on US\$150m announced, with definitive agreements and a schedule still to be established. 2025-09-18 — a privatisation memorandum was signed at a development round table ; 2026-07-17 — the minister met the counterparty's operations vice-president and the government declared the memorandum in its operational phase, with US\$150m announced covering network modernisation, a data centre and a connectivity programme, and definitive takeover agreements, a joint steering committee and a deployment schedule still to be established . The deal structure is undisclosed, the figure is the counterparty's own and appears in no appropriation. It is the fourth attempted rescue of this incumbent, the previous one agreed in November 2020 and needing EUR 20m having never been funded . The state is meanwhile budgeting FCFA 250,000,000 of its own telephone arrears to the same operator for a third year — negotiating a sale while owing the asset money.	ADVANCED
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	A vendor set out a four-axis electronic-government programme — a data centre, five relay sites, unified telephony and a police radio network — with no contract, amount or timetable. 2026-05-27 — a vendor delegation met the ministry on a package whose first axis is a national Tier III data centre ; 2026-06-03 — a working meeting set four axes: the data centre, five microwave-relay sites interconnecting ministries, unified telephony and videoconferencing, and a secure police radio network . Nothing existed before it and no contract, amount or timetable is stated; the programme is documented in no appropriation. These two accounts are the only sources under this subject the base holds for the country, and the fourth axis is carried by only one of them. The data centre it proposes is the same facility three other sponsors have proposed since 2022, reported under storage, and none of them has built it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	European financing runs a civil-status modernisation programme and a EUR 17.5m four-year programme digitising administrative fee collection across about twenty ministries. 2026-04-14 — an implementation workshop with three pilot ministries opened a programme financed at EUR 17.5m over four years, of which EUR 8.5m to one justice component, targeting the small revenues of about twenty ministries and covering issuance of the nationality certificate . It is a single source and no domestic appropriation for it is on file. 2026-02-20 — a steering committee validated the implementing partner's 2025 activities on the civil-status modernisation programme, extending from a capital-and-corridor pilot to new communes with a target of 400,000 birth certificates by 2028 , also a single source with no financing figure stated. Between them these two programmes carry the country's civil registration and its non-tax revenue collection, and neither appears in the national estimates — which is the fiscal shape of the whole digital record here.	ADVANCED
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	A Gulf memorandum signed at Bangui in July 2026 couples digital finance and land banking, with no commitment figure, schedule or governance arrangement. 2026-07-31 — a memorandum was signed at Bangui by the minister coordinating major works and strategic investments, covering digital finance and land banking, presented as mobilising investment for infrastructure while modernising land administration, with no commitment figure, disbursement schedule, timetable or governance arrangement stated . Nothing of the kind existed before it, and it is the only source under this subject the base holds; the counterparty is otherwise undocumented. It couples a payments ambition and a land-registry ambition under one offshore private counterparty, and registers as intent rather than finance. Land is the sensitive half. The country has already sold tokenised concessions with no functioning cadastre behind them, reported under the land register, and this memorandum proposes to modernise the register that sale ran ahead of.	ADVANCED
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Technical capacity, workforce and skills	an ICT workforce or skills assessment, a regulator or ministry capacity audit, or an operating record for the university digital training centre listed as delivered in 2023	not yet probed
National cybersecurity strategy, response team and operations centre	the promulgated cybersecurity law text, an agency establishment decree, or a national cybersecurity strategy	not yet probed
National open government data portal or catalogue	a government open-data portal with a dated dataset listing, or the data governance policy the public finances plan names and does not price	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Government interoperability or data-exchange layer	a decree or agency framework creating a government service bus or interoperability standard	not yet probed
Independent measurement of internet penetration	a regulator statistical bulletin, a statistics-institute survey module, or an operator-reported subscriber series filed with the regulator	not yet probed
Earth-observation or satellite data	any earth-observation agreement, geospatial data platform, national mapping programme or satellite-imagery procurement	not yet probed
Local-government digital systems	any commune-level platform, local revenue system, or territorial-administration programme document for the councils elected in December 2025	not yet probed
National AI policy, strategy or regulation	a published national AI strategy, a decree or bill on automated decision-making, or a continental AI-strategy accession instrument naming the country	not yet probed
AI system deployed in state service delivery	a procurement notice, contract, pilot announcement or ministry statement naming a deployed system and a vendor	not yet probed
Startup funding, accelerator cohort or ecosystem figure	a funding-round announcement, an incubator cohort list, or a tracker country figure	not yet probed
ICT sector size, revenue, employment or operator financials	a regulator annual report or observatory, a national-accounts ICT line, or operator segment disclosure	not yet probed
India-linked technology activity	a training-centre record, an export-bank line of credit for digital infrastructure, or an Indian vendor contract	not yet probed
Digital literacy programme	any dated ministry, regulator or donor document naming a digital-literacy programme with a scope or a budget line	not yet probed
Enacted appropriation for any year	a text-extractable copy of any of the three enacted finance laws, at line grain	not yet probed
Budget outturn at any grain	a text-extractable quarterly execution report, or a settlement law later than 2019	not yet probed

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